

vMix Lottery Title Data

Automatic date and next draw ID for every game title

DateText	Mon. 9th Sept. 2026
DrawID	10452 (last draw number + 1)

Covers: Daily 3, Play Way and Daily Pick 3 (Morning, Midday, Afternoon, Night) and Lotto. Super 6 is not included.

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1. How it works

vMix cannot write ordinal dates such as "9th" or "12th", and it cannot look up a draw number and add one to it. A small program, **vmix_lotto_data.py**, runs on the vMix computer and does this for you every 5 minutes.

- 1 It formats today's date from the PC clock, e.g. **Mon. 9th Sept. 2026**.
- 2 For every game and time period it finds the **last** draw number - from the NLA website, the email blast database, or a manual override - and adds 1.
- 3 It writes one small file per game into the **output** folder, e.g. `output\daily3_morning.csv`.
- 4 Each vMix preset reads its own file through a vMix **Data Source** and shows the two values in the title.
- 5 Optionally it also types the values straight into the title of whichever preset is open, using the vMix Web API.

Where the draw number comes from (tried in this order, for each game):

Order	Source	Notes
1	Manual override	overrides.json. Only used on the date written in it.
2	Website	about.nla.gd today. The address is one line in config.json.
3	Email blast database	SQLite, SQL Server, MySQL, Access or a CSV export.
4	Last good value	Kept in state.json if everything above fails.

Tip: Because the program runs every 5 minutes, as soon as a draw result is published the next draw ID for that game goes up by itself. Nobody has to type it in.

2. What you need

- The vMix computer (Windows 10 or 11) with vMix installed. Data Sources work in all vMix editions that support titles; the optional VB.NET script needs vMix 4K or Pro.
- Internet access on the vMix PC (for the website) and/or network access to the email blast database.
- Python 3 (free) - installed in step 3.
- This project folder (from GitHub, branch `claude/vmix-title-date-draw-id-omxzaj`).
- One vMix preset (.vmix file) per game and time period - 13 in total.

Game	Preset files
Daily 3	Daily 3 Morning, Daily 3 Midday, Daily 3 Afternoon, Daily 3 Night
Play Way	Play Way Morning, Play Way Midday, Play Way Afternoon, Play Way Night
Daily Pick 3	Daily Pick 3 Morning, Daily Pick 3 Midday, Daily Pick 3 Afternoon, Daily Pick 3 Night
Lotto	Lotto

3. Install Python

- 1 On the vMix PC open <https://www.python.org/downloads/> and click **Download Python 3.x**.
- 2 Run the installer. On the first screen tick **"Add python.exe to PATH"** at the bottom. This is the most important step.
- 3 Click **Install Now** and wait for "Setup was successful". Click Close.
- 4 Check it: press the Windows key, type **cmd**, press Enter, then type `py --version` and press Enter. You should see something like `Python 3.12.4`.

Important: If the check shows "not recognized", run the installer again, choose **Modify**, and make sure "Add Python to environment variables" is ticked.

Only if the email blast database is SQL Server, MySQL or Microsoft Access, also run this in the same command window:

```
py -m pip install pyodbc
```

4. Copy the files to the vMix PC

- 1 Open the GitHub repository **damionejdarbeau/vmixdatainput**.
- 2 Use the branch selector (top left of the file list) to choose `claude/vmix-title-date-draw-id-omxzaj`. The `.bat` files are on this branch.
- 3 Click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
- 4 Right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All...**
- 5 Move the extracted folder to `C:\vMixLotto` (any folder works, but this guide uses that one).

The folder should now contain these files:

```
C:\vMixLotto\  
  vmix_lotto_data.py      the program  
  config.json             settings (website, database, games)  
  overrides.example.json  example for manual draw numbers  
  run_once.bat            update once (for testing)  
  run_loop.bat            keep updating every 5 minutes  
  probe_website.bat       check what the website shows  
  install_autostart.bat   start automatically at log on  
  remove_autostart.bat    undo the automatic start  
  vmix_scripts\SetDateText.vb  
  docs\vMix_Lotto_Setup_Guide.pdf  (this guide)
```

Important: If Windows shows the `.bat` files as plain "Windows Batch File" but they do nothing, right-click one > **Properties** and tick **Unblock** at the bottom (files downloaded from the internet are sometimes blocked).

5. First test run

- 1 Double-click **run_once.bat** in `C:\vMixLotto`.
- 2 A black window opens and prints one line per game, for example:

```
[2026-10-03 09:15:02] Date text: Sat. 3rd Oct. 2026  
[2026-10-03 09:15:03]   daily3_morning           next draw 10452   (web)  
[2026-10-03 09:15:03]   daily3_midday            next draw 10453   (web)  
...  
[2026-10-03 09:15:04]   lotto                     next draw 2101   (sqlite)
```

- 1 A new folder **C:\vMixLotto\output** now holds 13 game files plus **all_games.csv**. Open **all_games.csv** in Excel or Notepad to check every value at once.
- 2 Press any key to close the window.

The word in brackets shows where each number came from: **web**, **sqlite/odbc/csv** (database), **override**, **cached** (last good value) or **none** (nothing found yet - the DrawID will be blank). Before you finish section 6, "none" is normal.

6. Tell the script where to find draw numbers

All settings are in **config.json**. Open it with Notepad (right-click > Open with > Notepad). Keep the quotes and commas exactly as they are; a missing comma stops the program from starting.

6a. The website

The website address is near the top:

```
"website_url": "https://about.nla.gd/",
```

When the address changes in future, change only this line and save.

Each game has a **label_regex** - the game name as it appears on the website. The program finds that name and reads the first *Draw ... number* that follows it. Check it against the real page:

- 1 Double-click **probe_website.bat**.
- 2 It lists every draw number found on the page with the text around it, and saves the same list to **probe_result.txt**.
- 3 Compare with config.json. For example, if the page says `PLAY WAY - NIGHT ... Draw No: 3512`, the default setting `Play\\s*Way\\W{0,20}Night` already matches it (`\\s*` means "any spaces", `\\W{0,20}` means "up to 20 symbols or spaces").
- 4 If the page uses another word for the number, e.g. *Game #3512*, add a `draw_regex` line to that game's web source (see below).

```
{ "type": "web",  
  "label_regex": "Play\\s*Way\\W{0,20}Night",  
  "draw_regex": "Game\\s*#\\s*(\\d+)",  
  "window": 400 }
```

Important: If probe_website.bat says it found nothing, the page is probably drawn by JavaScript. Use the database (6b) as the main source, or send probe_result.txt to whoever maintains the script so a JSON source can be set up.

6b. The email blast database

Each game also has a database source as a fallback. Change the file path, table and column names to match your email blast database. **params** are the game name and time period exactly as they are stored in the database.

SQLite database file:

```
{ "type": "sqlite",
  "database": "C:/EmailBlast/results.db",
  "query": "SELECT MAX(draw_number) FROM results WHERE game = ? AND period = ?",
  "params": ["Play Way", "Night"] }
```

SQL Server / MySQL / Access (needs pyodbc, see step 3):

```
{ "type": "odbc",
  "connection_string":
    "DRIVER={SQL Server};SERVER=DBPC;DATABASE=EmailBlast;Trusted_Connection=yes",
  "query": "SELECT MAX(DrawNo) FROM Results WHERE Game = ? AND Period = ?",
  "params": ["Play Way", "Night"] }
```

Spreadsheet export saved as CSV:

```
{ "type": "csv", "file": "C:/EmailBlast/export.csv", "column": "Draw",
  "filter": { "Game": "Play Way", "Period": "Night" } }
```

Tip: To make the database the **main** source, move its block above the web block inside that game's "sources" list. Use forward slashes (C:/folder/file) in paths, or double back-slashes (C:\\folder\\file).

6c. Manual override (when you need to type a number in)

- 1 Copy **overrides.example.json** and rename the copy to **overrides.json**.
- 2 Edit it so it lists only the games you want to force, with today's date and the draw ID to show:

```
{
  "playway_night": { "date": "2026-10-03", "next_draw": 3513 }
}
```

The override only applies on that date, so a forgotten override cannot show a wrong number tomorrow. The game names (keys) are listed in the Appendix.

7. Prepare the title in vMix

Do this once in the title design. If every preset uses the same title file, you only do it once.

- 1 Open the title (.gtzip) in **GT Title Designer**.
- 2 Select the text object for the date. In the properties panel set its **Name** to **DateText**.
- 3 Select the text object for the draw number and name it **DrawID**.
- 4 Save the title.
- 5 In vMix, right-click the title input > **Input Settings** > General, and set its name (title) to **LottoTitle**. Use this same name in every preset.

vMix will now list the fields as **DateText.Text** and **DrawID.Text**.

Tip: If your title already uses other field names, keep them and change "date_field" and "draw_field" in config.json to match (only needed for the Web API option in section 9).

8. Connect each preset to its data file

Repeat these steps in each of the 13 presets. Run **run_once.bat** first so the files exist.

- 1 Open the preset, e.g. **Daily 3 Morning.vmix**.
- 2 Open the **Data Sources Manager**. Depending on your vMix version this is the **Data Sources** button at the bottom of the main window, or under **Settings**.
- 3 Click **Add**, choose **Excel/CSV**, and browse to the file for this preset (table below), e.g. C:\vMixLotto\output\daily3_morning.csv. Click OK.
- 4 In the Data Sources Manager, turn on **Auto Refresh** and set it to **10** seconds. Make sure the first row is used as the header (column names **DateText** and **DrawID** should appear).
- 5 Open the title's **Title Editor** (click the cog on the title input, or right-click > Title Editor) and click **Data Source**.
- 6 For **DateText.Text** choose this data source and column **DateText**. For **DrawID.Text** choose column **DrawID**. Close the window.
- 7 Check the preview: the date and draw ID should appear in the title.
- 8 **Save the preset** (File/Save). The link is stored inside the .vmix file, so you never have to do this again for that preset.

Important: Each preset must point at **its own** file. A Night preset pointing at the Morning file will show the Morning draw ID.

Preset	Data file in C:\vMixLotto\output
Daily 3 Morning	daily3_morning.csv
Daily 3 Midday	daily3_midday.csv
Daily 3 Afternoon	daily3_afternoon.csv
Daily 3 Night	daily3_night.csv
Play Way Morning	playway_morning.csv
Play Way Midday	playway_midday.csv
Play Way Afternoon	playway_afternoon.csv
Play Way Night	playway_night.csv
Daily Pick 3 Morning	dailypick3_morning.csv
Daily Pick 3 Midday	dailypick3_midday.csv
Daily Pick 3 Afternoon	dailypick3_afternoon.csv
Daily Pick 3 Night	dailypick3_night.csv
Lotto	lotto.csv

Each file has a header row and one data row, for example:

```
Game,DateText,DrawID
Play Way Night,Sat. 3rd Oct. 2026,3513
```

9. Optional: direct push through the vMix Web API

This sends the values straight into the open preset's title, as well as writing the files. Use it if you prefer not to set up Data Sources, or as a second safety net. Both can be used together.

- 1 In vMix open **Settings > Web Controller**, tick **Enable**, keep port **8088**, and click OK.
- 2 In config.json check that "vmix_api" has "enabled": true and "title_input": "LottoTitle".
- 3 For every game check **preset_match**. It must be part of that preset's real file name (upper/lower case does not matter). If your file is called *Dail3 Morning.vmix*, use "preset_match": "Dail3 Morning".
- 4 Open a preset, run **run_once.bat**, and look for the line vMix: pushed ... into 'LottoTitle'.

Important: The program picks the first game whose preset_match is found in the file name. Keep the names specific, e.g. "Daily 3 Night" and "Daily Pick 3 Night", not just "Night".

10. Start automatically with Windows

- 1 Right-click **install_autostart.bat** and choose **Run as administrator**. Click Yes.
- 2 You should see "Done. The feeder will start each time you log on."
- 3 To start it now without logging off, double-click **run_loop.bat**.

A window titled **vMix Lotto Data Feeder** stays open and prints an update every 5 minutes. Minimise it, but do not close it. If the program stops for any reason, the window restarts it after 30 seconds.

To stop the automatic start, right-click **remove_autostart.bat** > Run as administrator.

Tip: To update more or less often, edit run_loop.bat and change - - loop 300 (seconds).

11. Daily checklist

- The **vMix Lotto Data Feeder** window is open on the vMix PC.
- Its latest lines show a draw number and **(web)** or a database source for each game - not **(none)** or **(cached)** for hours.
- The PC clock and date are correct (the date text comes from it).
- Before going on air, check the title preview: correct date and a draw ID one higher than the last published result.
- If a number is wrong, use an override (6c) and wait up to 5 minutes, or run run_once.bat to update immediately.

12. Changing things later

To change...	Edit	Example
Website address	config.json: website_url	"https://results.nla.gd/"
Month spelling	config.json: month_names	"Sep." instead of "Sept."
Day spelling	config.json: day_names	"Mon" without the dot
Date layout	config.json: pattern	"{day} {date} {month}, {year}" gives Mon. 9th Sept., 2026
Draw ID look	config.json: add "draw_format" to a game	"Draw #{0}" or "{0:06d}" (leading zeros)
Add / rename a game	config.json: copy a game block, change the key, name, preset_match and sources	Run run_once.bat to create its file
Update interval	run_loop.bat: --loop 300	--loop 120 = 2 minutes

The running program reloads config.json automatically on its next update, so there is no need to restart it after saving.

13. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Python was not found"	Repeat step 3 and tick "Add python.exe to PATH".
Window opens and closes at once	Run run_once.bat - it stays open and shows the error.
"Config file not found" or a JSON error	A quote or comma is missing in config.json. Open it at jsonlint.com to find the line.
DrawID is blank, source (none)	No source returned a number. Run probe_website.bat (6a) and check the database settings (6b). Use an override (6c) meanwhile.
"web source failed: urlopen error"	The website cannot be reached. Check internet access or the address in website_url. The database fallback will be used.
"sqlite source failed: unable to open database file"	The database path in config.json is wrong or the folder is not shared with the vMix PC.
"... lower than previous ... ignored"	A source returned an older number. Normally harmless; check the source if it keeps happening.
Title does not change in vMix	Check Auto Refresh is on and the field is bound to the right column (section 8). Open the CSV in Notepad to confirm it has the value.
"vMix API not reachable"	Only matters for section 9. Enable Settings > Web Controller.
"no game matches loaded preset"	Fix preset_match so it is part of the preset's file name (section 9).
Wrong date	Fix the Windows clock/time zone on the vMix PC.

Appendix: game keys

These names are used for the output files, overrides.json and config.json.

Key	Game	Default preset_match
daily3_morning	Daily 3 Morning	Daily 3 Morning
daily3_midday	Daily 3 Midday	Daily 3 Midday
daily3_afternoon	Daily 3 Afternoon	Daily 3 Afternoon
daily3_night	Daily 3 Night	Daily 3 Night
playway_morning	Play Way Morning	Play Way Morning
playway_midday	Play Way Midday	Play Way Midday
playway_afternoon	Play Way Afternoon	Play Way Afternoon
playway_night	Play Way Night	Play Way Night
dailypick3_morning	Daily Pick 3 Morning	Daily Pick 3 Morning
dailypick3_midday	Daily Pick 3 Midday	Daily Pick 3 Midday
dailypick3_afternoon	Daily Pick 3 Afternoon	Daily Pick 3 Afternoon
dailypick3_night	Daily Pick 3 Night	Daily Pick 3 Night
lotto	Lotto	Lotto

Date-only fallback without Python

vmix_scripts\SetDateText.vb sets only the date field from inside vMix (no draw ID). In vMix 4K/Pro: Settings > Scripting > Add, paste the file's contents, name it SetDateText, and start it from a shortcut or trigger. Use it only if the Python feeder cannot run.